

No More 4 AM Meows! These Smart Cat Feeders Are Game-Changers

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Picture this: it's 4 AM, and your cat is yowling for food like a tiny, furry alarm clock. Sound familiar? Well, technology has a purr-fect solution! Automatic cat feeders are here to save your sleep and keep your kitty happy.

These aren't your grandma's gravity bowls. Today's feeders connect to Wi-Fi and an app on your phone. You can schedule meals, give snacks from anywhere, and even watch your cat eat through a built-in camera. Some models, like the Petkit YumShare **Dual-Hopper 2** (\$170), use **AI** to see how much food is left and stop **dispensing** so your cat doesn't turn into a chunky fluffball.

But the real star? The Petlibro Polar Smart **Wet Feeder** (\$170). It's basically a mini-fridge for wet food! It keeps meals cool and fresh, then slides open a lid at mealtime. No more stinky, dried-out leftovers. The bowls are wide and shallow to protect your cat's sensitive whiskers, too.

WIRED tested 11 feeders and found options for every budget. The Petlibro **Granary** Camera Feeder (\$100) has a sharp camera and easy app. For a simpler pick, the Petlibro Air Feeder (\$60) is sleek and reliable. Even a dual-bowl model from **Oneisall** (\$50) works great if you don't mind a basic app.

So, whether you have a greedy gobbler or a picky nibbler, there's a smart feeder out there. Your cat might still be bossy, but at least you can sleep in!

Word Treasure

AI -- Short for artificial intelligence, a computer brain that can learn and make decisions on its own.

dual-hopper -- A feeder with two separate containers for different types of food, like one for dry kibble and one for treats.

dispensing -- The act of pushing out or giving out food from a machine in controlled amounts.

wet feeder -- A special feeder designed to store and serve wet or moist cat food, keeping it fresh.

granary -- A storage place for grain or dry food; here it refers to a feeder model that holds dry cat food.

Oneisall -- A brand that makes affordable automatic cat feeders with two bowls.

Background you need

Petkit is a Chinese brand known for smart pet products, and Petlibro is another popular maker of automated feeders.

Automatic feeders first became available years ago as simple gravity-driven bowls, but now they include cameras, apps, and even AI.

WIRED is a magazine and website that tests all kinds of tech gadgets to help people decide what to buy.

Break it down

WHO: Cat owners who want to stop early-morning meowing and several smart feeder companies.

WHAT: New automatic cat feeders with Wi-Fi, cameras, AI, and even built-in fridges to keep food fresh.

WHERE: These devices are used in homes anywhere, controlled through phone apps.

WHY: So cats can be fed on a schedule or remotely, and owners can sleep better while keeping their cats from overeating.

Why it matters

If you have a pet, this technology can help you take better care of it, just like a smartwatch helps you stay healthy--and it might stop a lot of early-morning wake-up calls!

Test what you remember

1. What time of day does the article say cats often yowl for food?

- ☐ (A) 2 AM
- ☐ (B) 4 AM
- ☐ (C) 6 AM
- ☐ (D) 8 AM

2. What does the Petlibro Polar Smart Wet Feeder do to keep food fresh?

- ☐ (A) It adds water automatically
- ☐ (B) It acts like a mini-fridge
- ☐ (C) It freezes the food
- ☐ (D) It covers the food with a lid

3. How many feeders did WIRED test?

- ☐ (A) 5
- ☐ (B) 11
- ☐ (C) 8
- ☐ (D) 15

4. Which feeder uses AI to check food level?

- ☐ (A) Petlibro Air Feeder
- ☐ (B) Oneisall dual-bowl model
- ☐ (C) Petkit YumShare Dual-Hopper 2
- ☐ (D) Petlibro Granary Camera Feeder

5. What is the price of the Petlibro Granary Camera Feeder?

- ☐ (A) \$50
- ☐ (B) \$100
- ☐ (C) \$170
- ☐ (D) \$60

6. Why are the bowls of the wet feeder wide and shallow?

- ☐ (A) To look nicer
- ☐ (B) To fit more food
- ☐ (C) To protect a cat's sensitive whiskers
- ☐ (D) To make cleaning easier

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: B 3: B 4: C 5: B 6: C

Questions to think about

1. **Happy pet owner view:** Owners love the convenience and peace of mind, knowing their cat is fed even when they are away or asleep.
2. **Concerned vet view:** Some experts worry that too much technology might replace human interaction with pets, which is important for bonding.
3. **Budget shopper view:** For people on a tight budget, the cheapest models work well enough, so you don't need to spend a lot to solve the yowling problem.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):